

Open Word. Then go to **File > Open**. In the “Files of type” list, click “Recover Text from Any File”, locate a Word file, and click Open. The document will open without any formatting. Look at the information at the end of the document—you may see stuff such as the name of the author and path of the document.

Microsoft themselves say that before you provide others with a copy of your document, it’s a good idea to view any hidden information and decide whether it’s appropriate to store that information. We’re wondering why there isn’t an option that says “Store no metadata”!

5.3.3 What To Do

The following are some steps you can take if you want to avoid sending metadata.

- Go to **Tools > Options**, then click the Security tab. Select the “Remove personal information from this file on save” checkbox in the Privacy options area, and click OK. Then save the document.
- You can also manually remove information from an already-stored document. Go to **File > Properties**. The Summary, Statistics, Contents, and Custom tabs may each contain information that you will want to remove. To remove it, highlight the information in each box and press [Del].
- Trying to remember the above for each of your documents, or ensuring that the others in your company do this, isn’t always practical. Fortunately, Word also provides the `RemovePersonalInformation` property, which, when set to `True`, removes all user information from comments, revisions, and the Properties dialog box when the user saves a document.

The following procedure creates a new document and adds code to the document’s Open “event” that sets `RemovePersonalInformation` to `True`. This ensures that person-